

MSP | MSP-11

Programme Governance Approach

How the programme will be directed and controlled

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Programme Governance Approach
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Date	18 Sep 2026
Author	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Owner	Programme Manager
Approver	Sponsoring Group
Classification	Internal
Retention	7 years from programme closure

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	04 Jun 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Initial draft
0.2	21 Jul 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Updated following workstream lead review
1.0	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Chief Platform Architect	Technical content and solution alignment	08 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Security, assurance and residency content	10 Sep 2026
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Finance Business Partner	Cost, funding and benefit figures	11 Sep 2026
M. Verity, Head of P3O	Head of P3O	Governance standards and completeness	15 Sep 2026

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO	Approved	18 Sep 2026
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	Director of Infrastructure	Approved	18 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Approved subject to closure of ISS-003	18 Sep 2026

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
MSP-16	Programme Definition Document	Contains this approach
MSP-15	Assurance Approach	Independent assurance arrangements

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Defines the governance structure, decision rights, delegations, tolerances, meeting cadence and control framework for the programme.
Framework	MSP — Decisions and Organization themes; created in Define the Programme
Created when	Define the Programme
Reviewed / updated	At each tranche boundary
Owner	Programme Manager
Approver	Sponsoring Group
Format options	Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.
Tailoring	Scale the depth of each section to the scale, risk and complexity of the work. Delete sections that add no value and record the tailoring decision in the governance approach.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- Decision rights are unambiguous at every level and no decision is unallocated
- Tolerances are set so that escalation is objective, not discretionary
- The governance load is proportionate to the programme
- The interface with corporate and portfolio governance is defined

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1. Governance principles

The Programme Board meets monthly, chaired by the Group CTO as Senior Responsible Owner, with the Director of Infrastructure, CISO, Finance Business Partner and the three consuming business unit heads. Delivery workstreams report weekly to the Programme Manager. The Agile Release Train holds PI planning quarterly, with Business Owners drawn from the same board. The P3O provides assurance, reporting standards and the RAID consolidation.

2. Governance structure

Insert the structure chart showing Sponsoring Group, Programme Board, SRO, Programme Manager, Business Change Managers, Programme Office, and project-level boards.

The Programme Board meets monthly, chaired by the Group CTO as Senior Responsible Owner, with the Director of Infrastructure, CISO, Finance Business Partner and the three consuming business unit heads. Delivery workstreams report weekly to the Programme Manager. The Agile Release Train holds PI planning quarterly, with Business Owners drawn from the same board. The P3O provides assurance, reporting standards and the RAID consolidation.

3. Bodies and their remit

Body	Purpose	Membership	Frequency	Chair	Quorum
Sponsoring Group	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO
Programme Board	Programme Helios	Programme Helios	Programme Helios	Programme Helios	Programme Helios
Business Change Forum	Defines the governance structure, decision rights, delegations, tolerances, meeting cadence and control framework for the programme.	C. Lindholm, platform engineer	Monthly	G. Lindqvist, Service Operations Lead	Bridge the hall B row 3 service void rather than relocate racks
Design Authority	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Programme Office	Programme Helios	Programme Helios	Programme Helios	Programme Helios	Programme Helios

4. Roles and accountabilities

Role	Accountable for	Decision rights	Name
Senior Responsible Owner	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO
Programme Manager	Programme Helios	Programme Helios	Programme Helios

Role	Accountable for	Decision rights	Name
Business Change Manager	<i>R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO</i>	<i>Deferred to the next Board</i>	<i>V. Chandra, Product Management</i>
Programme Office Manager	<i>Programme Helios</i>	<i>Programme Helios</i>	<i>Programme Helios</i>
Design Authority	<i>D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager</i>	<i>D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager</i>	<i>D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager</i>
Risk Manager	<i>No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance</i>	<i>No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance</i>	<i>No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance</i>
Benefits Manager	<i>No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation</i>	<i>No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation</i>	<i>No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation</i>

5. Decision rights matrix

Decision type	Programme Manager	Programme Board	SRO	Sponsoring Group
Approve project initiation	<i>Programme Helios</i>	<i>Programme Helios</i>	<i>R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO</i>	<i>R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO</i>
Approve change within tolerance	<i>Programme Helios</i>	<i>Programme Helios</i>	<i>R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO</i>	<i>R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO</i>
Approve change exceeding tolerance	<i>Programme Helios</i>	<i>Programme Helios</i>	<i>R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO</i>	<i>R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO</i>
Approve tranche closure	<i>Programme Helios</i>	<i>Programme Helios</i>	<i>R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO</i>	<i>R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO</i>
Approve business case revision	<i>Programme Helios</i>	<i>Programme Helios</i>	<i>R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO</i>	<i>R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO</i>
Approve programme closure	<i>Programme Helios</i>	<i>Programme Helios</i>	<i>Programme Helios</i>	<i>Programme Helios</i>
Accept risk above threshold	<i>No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance</i>	<i>Programme Helios</i>	<i>R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO</i>	<i>R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO</i>

6. Tolerances and escalation

Level	Time	Cost	Scope	Benefit	Risk	Escalate to
Project	2 hours	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	<i>In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.</i>	No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance	Programme Manager
Tranche	4 weeks	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	<i>In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the</i>	No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance	Programme Board

Level	Time	Cost	Scope	Benefit	Risk	Escalate to
			network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.			
Programme	Programme Helios	Programme Helios	Programme Helios	Programme Helios	Programme Helios	Sponsoring Group

7. Reporting cycle

Report	From	To	Frequency	Due
Project highlight report	Significant impact with a workaround available — response within one working day	Significant impact with a workaround available — response within one working day	Significant impact with a workaround available — response within one working day	Significant impact with a workaround available — response within one working day
Programme highlight report	Significant impact with a workaround available —	Programme Helios	Programme Helios	Programme Helios

Report	From	To	Frequency	Due
	<i>response within one working day</i>			
End of tranche review	26 Feb 2027	25 Jun 2027	25 Jun 2027	30 Nov 2026
Benefits review	No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation	No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation	No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation	No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation
Assurance report	26 Feb 2027	Monthly benefit tracking report	Each iteration	31 Mar 2027

8. Meeting calendar

Meeting	Cadence	Standing agenda	Secretariat
Programme Board pack	Fortnightly	31 Jan 2027	Carried forward from the Tranche 1 lessons register
Workstream status return	Each planning interval	26 Feb 2027	Evidenced in the Tranche 2 gate pack, section 4
ART sync record	Weekly	31 Mar 2027	Reviewed at each PI boundary by the Release Train Engineer
System demo	Each iteration	23 Apr 2027	Verified at hall A acceptance on 26 Feb 2027
Tenant onboarding bulletin	At each stage boundary	28 May 2027	Confirmed with the FM provider under the existing facilities contract

9. Interface with corporate and portfolio governance

The Programme Board meets monthly, chaired by the Group CTO as Senior Responsible Owner, with the Director of Infrastructure, CISO, Finance Business Partner and the three consuming business unit heads. Delivery workstreams report weekly to the Programme Manager. The Agile Release Train holds PI planning quarterly, with Business Owners drawn from the same board. The P3O provides assurance, reporting standards and the RAID consolidation.

10. Tailoring of MSP for this programme

Element	Standard	Tailored approach	Rationale
Service operations readiness for liquid-cooled infrastructure, including leak response	Delegated to the Programme Manager within tolerance; above tolerance to the Programme Board	Replaced by the equivalent record in the ALM tool	Grid capacity at DXB-1 supports Tranche 2 in full, so a second site is not yet justified
400G RoCEv2 leaf-spine fabric tuned for collective communication at 256-GPU job scale	Reviewed at each end-of-tranche review and updated by change control only	Combined with the adjacent product to reduce document count	Air cooling would cap density at 12 kW per rack and require 2.4 times the floor area
Multi-tenant orchestration with fair-share quota across AI Research, Fraud Analytics and Retail	Enforced automatically in the pipeline; manual assertion is not accepted as evidence	Applied in full	Grid capacity at DXB-1 supports Tranche 2 in full, so a second site is not yet justified
Parallel filesystem tier of 12 PB usable sustaining 1.2 TB/s to the compute estate	Any deviation requires a recorded waiver accepted by the CISO with a stated expiry	Not used — recorded in the tailoring decision record	Air cooling would cap density at 12 kW per rack and require 2.4 times the floor area